

Djokovic fights back to win in Beijing

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Novak Djokovic had to work hard to keep his winning record in Beijing. The six-time **champion** beat China's Bu Yunchaokete to reach the third round of the China Open.

Bu won the first set, but Djokovic fought back to win 4-6, 7-6 (7-2), 6-2. The match lasted two hours and 52 minutes. Djokovic has now played 31 matches in Beijing without losing.

The 39-year-old Serbian player needed a **medical timeout** during the second set. This is a pause that lets a player receive medical attention. He also spoke with the trainer before taking control of the **tie-break**. A **tie-break** is a special scoring game used to settle a close set.

In the final set, Djokovic won four games in a row. He finished the match with a winning backhand shot.

Aryna Sabalenka also made a strong start to her China Open campaign. The world number two beat Mexico's Renata Zarazua 6-1, 6-3 in 63 minutes and hit 11 **aces**. An ace is a successful serve the other player does not touch.

Sabalenka said she was trying to be easier on herself. Expecting a lot from herself can drive her forward, she explained, but it can also use up her **energy**. Her next **opponent** was set to be Nikola Bartunkova.

Word Treasure

champion -- A player who has won a competition.

medical timeout -- A pause for a player to receive medical attention.

tie-break -- A special scoring game used to settle a close set.

aces -- Successful serves that the other player does not touch.

opponent -- The player someone competes against.

energy -- The strength to keep doing something.

Background you need

An ace is a successful serve that the other player does not touch.

A medical timeout pauses play so a player can receive medical attention.

Break it down

Introduces Djokovic's victory and place in the third round.

Gives the score, match length and unbeaten record.

Explains the medical timeout, tie-break and final set.

Reports Sabalenka's win and her comments about expectations.

Why it matters

Djokovic extended his unbeaten record in Beijing after losing the opening set. Sabalenka described how high expectations can both motivate her and use up her energy.

Test what you remember

1. Who did Djokovic beat to reach the third round?

- ☐ (A) Aryna Sabalenka
- ☐ (B) Bu Yunchaokete
- ☐ (C) Nikola Bartunkova
- ☐ (D) Renata Zarazua

2. How did Djokovic's match begin?

- ☐ (A) Djokovic won the first set.
- ☐ (B) They began with a tie-break.
- ☐ (C) They began with a medical timeout.
- ☐ (D) Bu won the first set.

3. How long did Djokovic's match last?

- ☐ (A) Two hours and 52 minutes
- ☐ (B) Two hours and 12 minutes
- ☐ (C) One hour and 52 minutes
- ☐ (D) Three hours and 12 minutes

4. What is a tie-break used for?

- ☐ (A) To choose the next opponent
- ☐ (B) To count a player's aces
- ☐ (C) To settle a close set
- ☐ (D) To pause for medical attention

5. How many aces did Sabalenka hit?

- ☐ (A) Eleven aces
- ☐ (B) Nine aces
- ☐ (C) Seven aces
- ☐ (D) Thirteen aces

6. What did Sabalenka say she was trying to do?

- ☐ (A) Play more matches in Beijing
- ☐ (B) Change her next opponent
- ☐ (C) Be easier on herself
- ☐ (D) Expect more from herself

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: B 2: D 3: A 4: C 5: A 6: C

Questions to think about

1. Aryna Sabalenka: She said expecting more from herself can drive her forward but can also drain her energy, and she is trying to be easier on herself.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):